

Testing and integration of 5G software and hardware by October

India's aim of taking lead in the sector of 5G deployment may come soon as the 5G Test Bed being indigenously devel-



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oped here may start offering testing and integration of software and hardware this October. It is to be noted here that India's 5G Test Bed was announced back in 2018 and a total outlay of more than ₹2.24 billion was announced for the same. The government has already disbursed ₹450 million during 2020-21 for the project. An amount of approximately ₹30 million has been utilised from the same.

Agencies empaneled to boost adoption of energy-efficient products and services

With the aim to maximise the adoption of energy-efficient products and services in the country, Energy Efficiency Services Limited (EESL), a joint venture under Ministry of Power, government of India, has decided to empanel corporate sales agencies, direct sales agencies, dealers and retailers, and other demand aggregators, including ESCOs, for the requisite under the Success Fee Model. Through this, EESL seeks to boost and expand the sale of its various existing and new products and services in the market.

India's mobile phone exports grew 50% in December over previous year

The overall electronics goods exports in the month of December 2020 reached a level of ₹88.06 billion. Mobile phones were the highest contributor in the segment, comprising 35 percent of the

value with an export value of ₹30.61 billion, which is 50 percent higher than December 2019. The rollout of the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) scheme, applicable from 1st January this year, can help boost the exports further by a specific process of determining the rates and identifying the product lines.

India's wearables market posts 144.3% YoY growth in 2020

The wearables market in India posted a remarkable 144.3 percent year-over-year (YoY) growth in 2020, exiting 2020 with 36.4 million unit shipments, according to the International Data Corporation's (IDC) Worldwide Quarterly Wearable Device Tracker. India was the only country in the top 20 to



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see triple-digit growth in wearables in 2020 and continues to be the third-largest wearables market globally. This growth was majorly driven by the increasing acceptance of earwear devices and upgrades to watches from wrist bands, both recording their highest annual shipments in 2020.

India's first engineering R&D policy announced in Karnataka

The engineering R&D (E R&D) sector is one of the fastest growing industries in India, said Karnataka's Deputy Chief Minister Dr C.N. Ashwath Narayana while launching a policy around the same. Notably, this E R&D policy has become first of its kind in

the country. The minister noted that the aim of the policy is to contribute approximately 45 percent to India's engineering R&D needs during the policy tenure.

India can produce Tesla EVs at lesser cost than China

The Transport Minister of India Nitin Gadkari has declared that their government would ensure that the production cost of electric vehicles (EVs) for Tesla is lower than that in China, if the electric cars giant manufactures electric vehicles in India. India, at the moment, does not have a comprehensive EV policy in place. The minister mentioned that, with 80 percent of the lithium-ion cells being made in India, the country can also be a major market for USA based Tesla. It is to be noted here that Tesla has recently set up its first office in India. The company has received invitations from several state governments

to set up a manufacturing facility.

BSNL proposes hybrid tender model for telecom equipment companies

Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL) has proposed two models for sourcing telecom equipment for installing the same across different sites in India. Financial Express reported that the proposal looks inclined towards providing a fair play to both Indian and foreign telecom equipment providers. BSNL employees, as per several media reports, had criticised the government for forcing the company to purchase telecom equipment from India based manufacturers. The employees have called equipment manufactured by these as sub-standard.